Assignment 4 — Daily Compass

Design proposal (updated 2 October 2026; demo shown under the brand name Celestra). The official brief asks for an AI daily fortune system but specifies neither platform nor method. Daily Compass is a responsive web experience for adults who enjoy short, low-risk daily reflection. Its astrology-inspired and card-based interpretations are entertainment, not scientifically validated predictions.

Core loop: Signal → Why → Action → Reflection. Show a theme, the source signals and rule behind it, one optional small action, and an evening check-in. "Why" describes inputs and rules, not model chain-of-thought.

The expanded product answers **today, week, month and year** questions across **love, career, study and money**, plus direct questions such as "Will I get this job?" and "Will my ex return?" A **Safety Gate** runs first, then the intent router selects a suitable method and answer format. The method framework ranks methods by product fit and implementation burden, never predictive accuracy. Question examples show calibrated, concrete responses.

4.1 Features

Priority	Feature	Purpose
POC	General daily reading, or optional Sun-sign context from a birth date	Let users try without identity; the derived sign stays in this browser.
POC	Daily Compass card (theme, colour of the day, card of the day, what to watch for)	Short reading, one set per day, same result on reopening.
POC	Ask with Tarot: career, relationship, or a single-card spread	Specific questions answered with a visible card draw (shuffled with a seed from the date and topic, so the same question today gives the same cards) and fixed card meanings.
POC	"Why this reading?"	Show the calculated inputs, the selected rule and the profile precision.
POC	Thai weekday colour, birth-day deity and light remedies	Familiar Thai cultural framing for "bad luck" or stress; labelled as custom/ritual, not a way to change luck.
POC	Stress and crisis path	Small actionable steps for stress; if distress wording is detected, show support panel and the Department of Mental Health hotline **1323** instead of a reading.
POC	"Which astrology is most accurate?" page	State plainly that no system is proven; show which method suits which kind of question.
POC	One safe action	Turn the theme into a small, reversible, optional action.
POC	Evening reflection	Relevance/usefulness scores and an optional private note, stored locally.
MVP	Birth chart; day/week/month/year scope; love/career/study/money filters	Longer and shorter horizon readings from precise profile data and reviewed rules.
MVP	78-card Tarot catalog and I Ching decision mode	Expand question formats after validating the POC.

Priority	Feature	Purpose
Production	History, language/timezone preferences, opt-in reminders	Support repeat use and user control.
Experimental system API	Vedic timing	Sidereal Moon/nakshatra and Vimshottari periods; withheld from users until a specialist validates it.

Example question handling (behaviour tested against the running POC):

Question	Answer format
Will I get the job I just interviewed for?	3 cards (“possible opportunity”), no prediction of the employer's decision.
Will I have work this month?	30-day theme, watch-outs and preparation; states the hiring outcome is the employer's decision.
Should I invest in stocks?	Reading plus a notice that it is not investment advice.
Bad luck lately — what can I do?	Colour of the day and practical steps: separate real causes from the feeling of bad luck, pick one fixable thing, note that remedies need not cost money.
Should I worship or believe in something to improve my life?	Says outcomes cannot be guaranteed; follow your own belief or consult a trusted religious advisor; belief is not stored.
Very stressed, want advice	Small immediate steps, no prediction.
Text suggesting self-harm	Support panel with 1323 only; no reading, no cards.
Which astrology is the best?	No system is scientifically proven; see which one fits which question.

Guest mode receives a general theme. The POC birth-chart page (Western, tropical) asks for date, time (optional) and a place chosen from a list; the server calculates in memory and the browser stores only what is needed on that device, with a delete button. If the birth time is unknown the page says the Ascendant and houses are unreliable. Nothing is kept server-side. A later registered product needs separate consent, precision handling and a feature justification.

Method roles: Western astrology supplies profile and time-horizon themes; Tarot handles question-specific situations; I Ching frames decisions and change; the experimental Vedic endpoint exposes traditional long-horizon timing structure. A proposed “lucky color,” conflict-avoidance prompt, or harmless remedy is labeled as a Thai custom/reflective ritual, not a mechanism that changes luck. A deity question receives respectful belief exploration with the user's tradition and consent, never a claim that a deity is objectively assigned or that worship guarantees life improvement.

Packages (production hypothesis, untested)

Paid tiers sell **depth, convenience and continuity**, never safety. The crisis path, the “Why this reading?” explanation and the accuracy disclaimer stay free in every tier. Nothing is sold as a way to “fix” bad luck.

Package	Who it is for	Included	Positioning
Free (guest or account)	Curious first-time visitor	Daily Compass card, colour/card of the day, 1 Tarot question per day, Why, evening reflection	A calm daily ritual you can try with no identity. This is the acquisition tier.

Package	Who it is for	Included	Positioning
Plus (monthly subscription)	Daily habit users who ask about work, love and money	More questions per day (fair-use cap), week/month scopes, love/career/study/money filters, birth chart, history, reminders	“Come back every day and keep your own record.” Value is continuity and personalization.
Deep Reading (one-off purchase)	Someone at a decision point (job change, new relationship, new year)	One long reading on a chosen topic or year, with the sources/rules shown and a saved copy	Pay only when needed, which suits users who do not want a subscription.

The prices below are test ranges, not selling prices. The market reference points come from search results dated 2 October 2026 and are not confirmed on the source pages (see 4.2); Thai willingness to pay has not been measured. The ranges exist to find out what users will pay:

Package	Test range (THB)	Why this range	How to test
Free	0	Acquisition tier. Per-user cost is low because the facts are computed in code and the AI wording is optional and consent-gated.	Measure retention before deciding on any paywall.
Plus	79 / 129 / 199 per month	All three points sit below the subscription prices the search results show for a Thai daily-horoscope app (weekly 185, monthly 320, yearly 1,150). Plus does not claim to be more accurate, so it should not price against an app with an established base. 199 matches the 15-minute live-reading price of Star360 (199), so it is the ceiling of the test.	Paywall A/B in the pilot, three price groups.
Deep Reading	249 / 399 / 590 per reading	One long reading for a topic or a year, with sources and a saved copy. The low end starts slightly above Star360's 15-minute live price because the output is longer and kept; the high end tests whether anyone pays a full-price lump sum.	Paywall A/B plus a Van Westendorp survey.

Limit to state plainly: a 15-minute live reading at 199 THB against Deep Reading from 249 THB does not show Deep Reading is cheaper than a live fortune-teller. A price advantage can be claimed only for Plus. Deep Reading has to be sold on convenience, privacy and checkable sources, not on price. All competitor figures come from search results rather than the live pricing pages, and a weekly app subscription cannot be compared directly with our monthly one.

Thai baht with PromptPay-style local payment is the default checkout. Publish a price only after the pilot shows who pays and why.

What “worth paying for” can honestly mean: readings that users rate as relevant and useful *more than a mismatched reading*, answers that are specific to their question, and clear sources. It does not mean predictions proven correct, which this design cannot show.

4.2 Market positioning

Product	Observed offering from official source	Daily Compass emphasis
Co–Star	Birth date/time/place, personalized astrology and friend compatibility; the company describes astronomical data with human and AI interpretation.	Plain-language source/rule explanation plus a same-day usefulness check.
CHANI	Daily horoscopes, personalized transits, meditations, a journal and reflection prompts; it says astrologers write its content.	Put signal, explanation, one action and same-day reflection in a compact reading flow.
Faladdin	Personalized fortune readings including submitted coffee-cup photos; its terms list multiple methods.	Focus initially on one daily ritual and explicit source-level explanation.

Official pages checked **1 October 2026**. This describes published capabilities, not a complete product audit. The proposed differentiation is the **combination and emphasis** of explanation, action and feedback in one daily flow. It is a hypothesis to test, not a claim of superior accuracy or that competitors lack reflection.

Thai market price reference points (not confirmed on source pages)

These come from search results dated 2 October 2026 only, because the source pages could not be opened while this was written. **Re-check them on the official pages before relying on them or setting a price.**

Example	Price / format as summarised by search	Source
Thai app “ดูดวงรายวัน ดวงวันนี้”	Subscriptions: weekly 185 THB, monthly 320 THB, yearly 1,150 THB	App Store (TH)
Star360	Online reading with a fortune-teller, from 199 THB for 15 minutes	star360.net
ดวง Live (Duang Live)	Live readings in an app; says it has over 1,000 fortune-tellers	duanglive.com

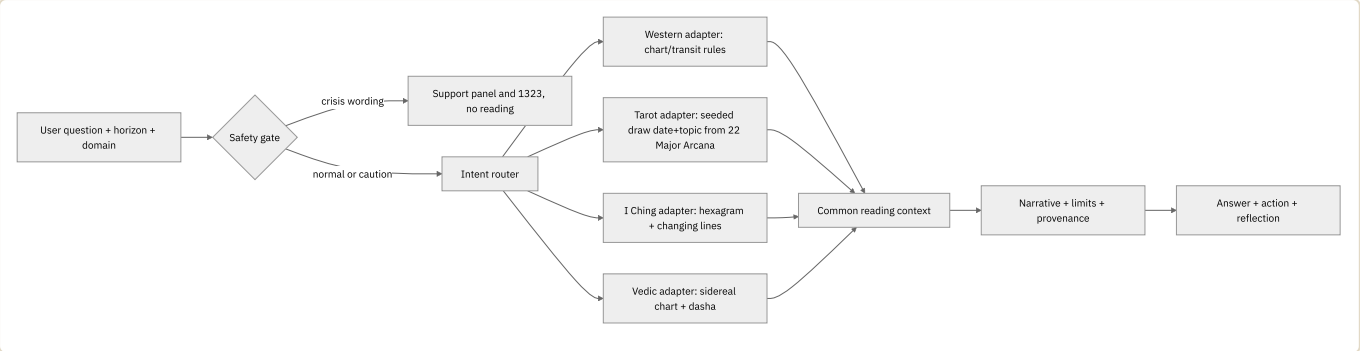
What this table supports: the Thai market appears to have two poles, app subscriptions at a few hundred baht a month and direct payment to a live fortune-teller billed by time. No pay-per-reading, instant, source-checkable product was found, which is why Plus is tested below app-subscription prices. The figures do not prove the gap exists.

Proposed differentiators (to test with users, not claims of being better or that competitors lack them):

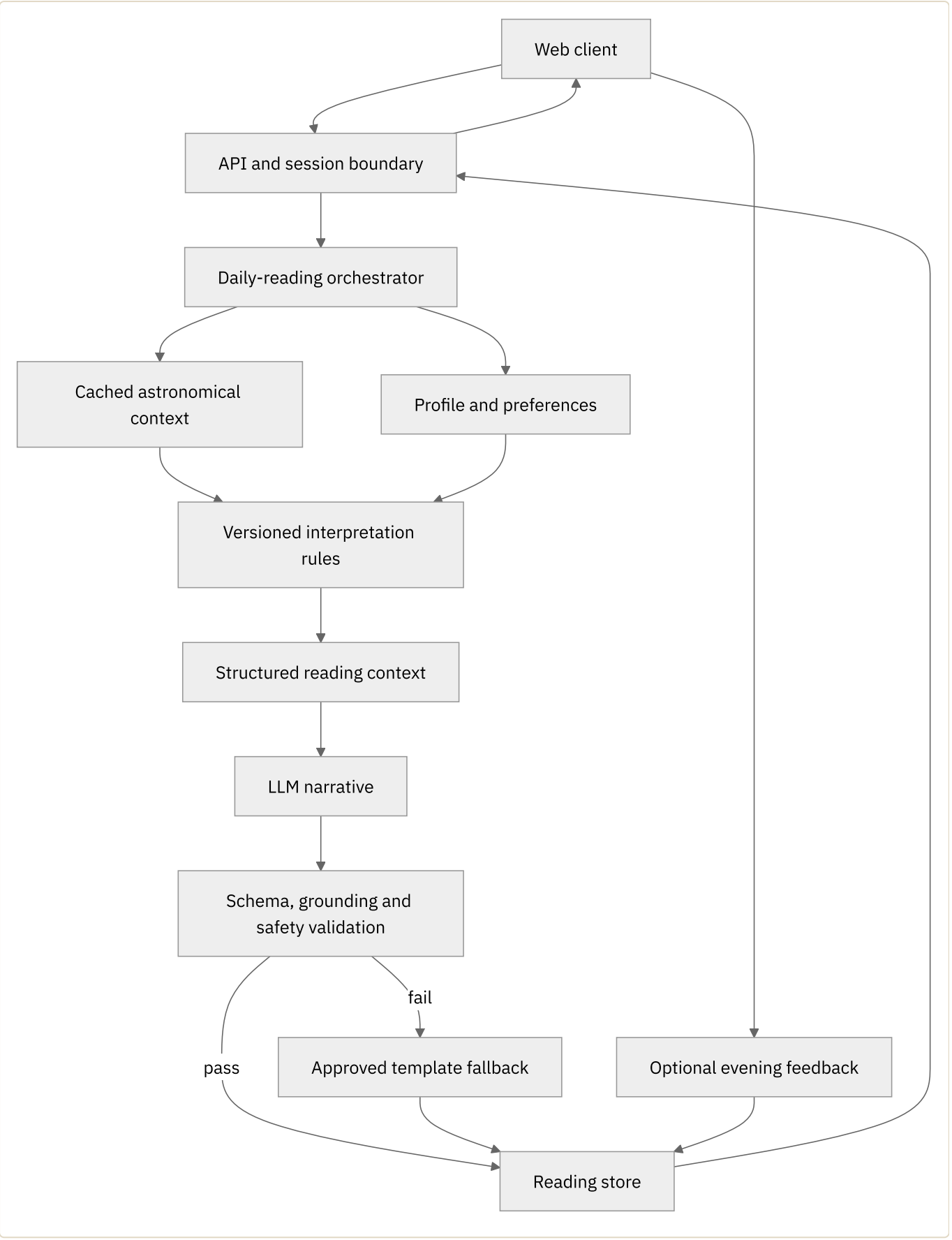
1. **Thai-first with Thai custom:** weekday colour, birth-day deity and remedies that need no spending, labelled as custom.
2. **Safety before fortune:** crisis wording gets a support panel and 1323, no prediction; high-risk questions get a notice.
3. **No fatalism:** questions like “will I get the job” return themes, possibilities and things the user can control, with limits stated.
4. **Repeatable:** cards are drawn server-side by date and question; asking again returns the same set, with answer and version.
5. **Candid about accuracy:** a page saying no astrology is proven most accurate and what each method suits.
6. **Minimal data:** the question API does not store questions; the POC has no server-side user data.

4.3 Technical blueprint

The multi-method design adds `Safety Gate → Intent Router → Method Adapter` before source calculation/draw. The Safety Gate runs first: crisis wording returns the support panel and 1323 with no reading; other high-risk topics continue with a notice attached. Routing uses explicit user choices first; later AI classification may suggest a mode with user override. Each adapter returns a common evidence envelope: method, horizon, domain, source IDs, rule/catalog version, interpretation, limitations and allowed actions. The narrative layer cannot invent a different method result.



The POC includes daily-lite and sampled-horizon Western themes, Western tropical natal calculations, Tarot question readings, I Ching coin-cast plus King Wen identity, and an experimental Vedic timing endpoint. I Ching classical line text remains future work. The daily request path below is the implemented Western-lite case.



1. **Astronomical calculation:** use a pinned local ephemeris and calculation library for dated positions. JPL Horizons can independently check positions; it does not validate astrology. Skyfield is a POC candidate with an MIT license. Check coordinate conventions, kernel coverage and data-file rights before implementation.

2. **Interpretation:** a documented, versioned astrology-inspired rule maps positions and available profile precision to theme, supporting signal IDs and allowed action categories. Meanings are product rules, not scientific facts.
3. **LLM:** receives only validated context, language and tone. It returns `signal`, `reading`, `why`, `action` and `reflection_prompt`. It cannot add positions, rule outcomes or unsupported personal claims.
4. **Validator:** checks schema, lengths, source/rule grounding and prohibited high-stakes or fatalistic content. One bounded retry, then a curated fallback; unsafe drafts are never shown.
5. **Consistency:** unique `(subject_id, local_date, methodology_version)` reading. Reuse the first successful result. Timezone changes apply on the next reading day. Store calculator/kernel, rule, prompt and model versions.

The current POC is one local web service plus browser storage, with on-demand generation. A production registered product can add a relational database, shared precomputed context, jobs and opt-in notifications as volume requires. If calculation data is unavailable, use verified cached context or fail gracefully; never invent sky positions. If the LLM fails, use approved static wording. Notification failure does not erase the reading. Log IDs, versions, latency and errors without reflection text.

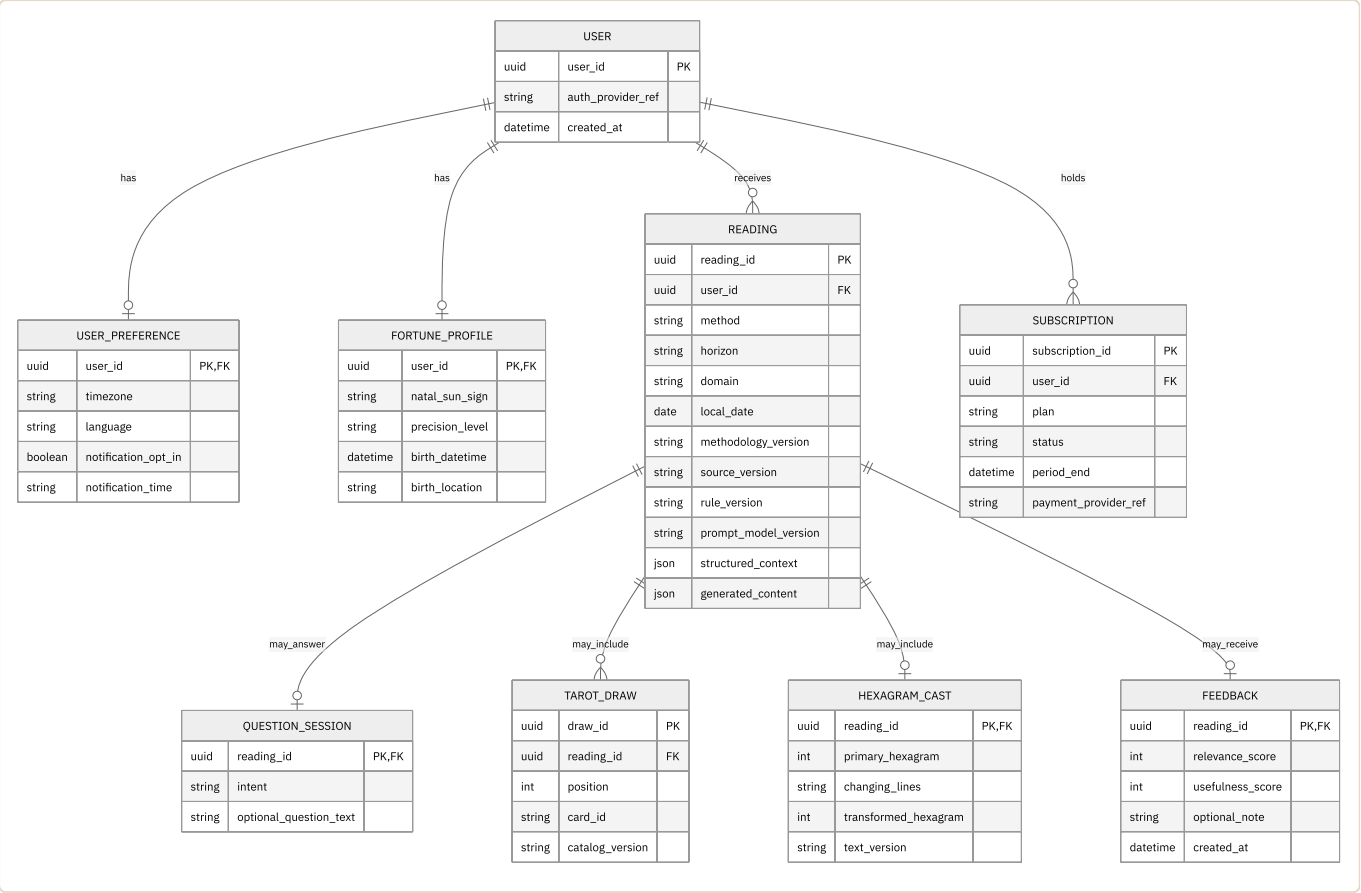
4.4 Data and ER diagram

Yes, for registered users who choose personalization/history. Guests can receive an unlinked general reading without a persistent account. Free-text question and reflection are optional and private by default. Precise birth date, time and location would be collected only for a full chart feature; the POC does not store them. Religion/deity preference is not inferred or stored by default.

Data	Purpose	Need and sensitivity
Account ID, auth-provider reference	Sign-in and sync	Registered only; personal.
Birth date or derived Sun sign	Approximate Sun-sign interpretation	Optional; store derived sign if exact date is no longer needed.
Timezone, language	Correct local day and display	Timezone needed; language can default.
Notification opt-in/time	Reminders	Production only, explicit opt-in.
Date, source/rule IDs, content and versions	Stable result, history and audit	Registered only; personal.
Scores and optional note	Reflection and evaluation	Optional; note may be sensitive.
Selected method, horizon, domain, rule/source IDs	Route and reproduce a reading	Per reading; low to personal.
Optional question text and Tarot draw/hexagram result	Answer and replay a consented question reading	Sensitive text; allow ephemeral mode and deletion.
Plan, billing status, payment-provider reference	Charge and renew	Paid users only; no card numbers stored by us.
Question category only (not the text), as an aggregate event	Learn which topics users ask about (work, love, money…)	Anonymous count by default; text stays ephemeral.

Data	Purpose	Need and sensitivity
Exact birth time/place, if full chart enabled	Calculate precise chart/houses and timezone	Optional, sensitive; collect only for that mode.

No contacts, live GPS, health or financial records, or private messages. Restrict access, encrypt sensitive data, offer deletion of reading/note/account, and set retention periods with a product/privacy owner before launch. Do not claim legal compliance from this design alone.



A registered profile remains optional because Tarot and I Ching need no birth data. A `READING` has one method/horizon/domain, and only the method-specific result that applies. `FEEDBACK` is 0..1 per reading; a daily reading is unique per user/local date/method version, while question readings can be repeated. Guest responses are ephemeral and excluded from this registered-user ERD. ERD.md gives the storage and deletion rules. Method catalogs are application configuration, not user data.

4.5 KPIs

What success means here. Not “the predictions are correct”: the system cannot show that, and no KPI claims it. Success is (1) users find a reading **relevant and useful**, (2) they **return**, (3) a share of them **pay and keep paying**, (4) all of it at a **safe, affordable cost** to serve. No baseline, target or result is claimed. Targets are set *after* a pilot produces a baseline.

North star: weekly returning users = distinct users with a completed reading in week *W* **and** in week *W+1*. Guest sessions are counted separately because cross-device identity is unknown. Do not optimize fear, urgency or time spent.

1. Product value (is it worth paying for?)

KPI	Definition
Activation rate	First-time visitors who see a card or answer ÷ visitors, within the first session. Also time to first card.
Question answered rate	Questions answered with a rating of "answered my question" ≥ threshold ÷ questions asked.
Relevance / usefulness	Mean and distribution of the 1–5 evening scores, plus response rate (to show selection bias).
Personalization lift (anti-Barnum test)	In a pilot A/B, some users see a reading generated for a *different* profile or question. Lift = mean relevance (own reading) − mean relevance (mismatched reading). If lift ≈ 0, the reading feels "accurate" only because it is generic, so it is not a reason to pay.
Why-engagement	Readings where Why was expanded ÷ readings shown.

2. Retention

KPI	Definition
D1 / D7 / D30 retention	Users from first-reading cohort *C* with a completed reading on day *N* (or within the day-N window) ÷ size of *C*. Split guest vs registered, free vs paid.
Weekly returning users	The north star above.
Reading streak	Median consecutive days with a completed reading among registered users.

3. Business (monetization)

KPI	Definition
Visitor → registered	Registered accounts ÷ unique visitors in the period.
Free → paid conversion	Users who start a paid plan or buy a Deep Reading ÷ active free users in the same period. Report by entry point (paywall shown after which feature).
Trial → paid	Paid after trial ÷ trials started.
ARPU / ARPPU	Revenue ÷ all active users; revenue ÷ paying users.
Monthly churn (subscriptions)	Subscribers lost in month ÷ subscribers at start of month.
LTV / CAC	LTV ≈ ARPPU × gross margin ÷ churn; CAC = acquisition spend ÷ new paying users. Report the ratio and payback months only once real data exist.
One-off repurchase rate	Deep Reading buyers who buy again within 90 days ÷ buyers.
Refund / complaint rate	Refunds or "not as described" reports ÷ paid orders.
Willingness-to-pay	Price-survey curves and paywall A/B results from the pilot. Used to set prices.

4. Demand discovery (do Thai users ask what we assume?)

KPI	Definition
Question-category mix	Share of questions by category (work, love, money, study, stress, other), stored as an anonymous count, never the question text. This tests the assumption that these topics dominate before roadmap and pricing decisions rely on it.
Method preference	Share of questions answered via Tarot / Western / I Ching, and **method override rate** (user switches the suggested method).
Draw completion	Tarot draws completed ÷ started.

5. AI quality, safety and trust

KPI	Definition
Structured-output validity	Responses that pass schema, grounding and safety validation ÷ responses generated.
Supported-signal rate	Sampled readings whose claims all trace to a signal/rule ÷ sampled readings (human review).
Fallback rate	Readings served from the approved template ÷ readings.
High-stakes violation rate	Fixed eval set of risky prompts (investment, medical, legal, death certainty, spending pressure): outputs breaking a rule ÷ prompts. Release gate.
Crisis-routing recall	Eval prompts with crisis wording that correctly return the support panel (with 1323) and no reading ÷ all crisis prompts. Release gate; any miss is investigated.
User reports	Content reports per 1,000 readings.

6. Reliability and cost

KPI	Definition
Reading success rate	Successful readings ÷ requests. API errors, P50/P95 latency, notification failures.
AI cost per completed reading	LLM spend ÷ completed readings; **gross margin per paying user** = (revenue − AI, compute and payment fees) ÷ revenue.
Context-cache hit rate	Cached astronomical context reuses ÷ lookups.

Guardrail metrics (must not get worse while growth KPIs improve)

- Share of paid conversions that follow a distress or fear-related query. If this is high, the paywall may be exploiting anxiety, so redesign it.
- Crisis path and safety notices remain free and undelayed in every plan.
- Complaints about pressure to spend, and refund rate on Deep Readings.

How these are used

Safety and reliability are release gates. Business KPIs are read only alongside value KPIs: a rise in conversion with a falling relevance score or rising refunds is a warning, not a win. Segment by method, horizon, domain and plan. “It came true” is subjective feedback, never reported as scientific accuracy. Pilot plan: recruit a small group,

measure the baselines above for a few weeks, run the mismatched-reading test and price survey, then set targets and decide whether a paid tier is justified.

POC and production

The working POC demonstrates daily/period theme generation, a stateless question API, Tarot draws, seeded by date and topic, from the 22 Major Arcana (the data catalog holds 78 cards, but the 56 Minor cards have no card art and are never drawn), Western tropical natal placements/angles/Whole Sign houses/major aspects, I Ching line casting with King Wen hexagram identity, and an experimental Vedic timing endpoint. The responsive website has seven pages: Today, Ask, Tarot (pick three cards from a fan, then predict), Birth chart, Lucky colour and rituals, Which method is accurate, and Stress support, linked by a scrollytelling home page. I Ching and Vedic timing are available through the API, not as pages. Paid packages, subscriptions and payments are design only and are not implemented. It uses `astronomy-engine@2.1.19` for local source calculation. Optional OpenAI structured output rephrases the original daily reading only; the live call remains unverified without an API key. Tarot question text is not persisted or returned in API responses. There is no server-side user-data store. Playwright captures the current desktop flows and checks mobile layout. A router and safety evaluation set lives in `poc/eval` (112 development and 43 held-out Thai and English questions, labelled by the developer and not real user data) with a regression gate in the tests. On the held-out set the router's exact-route accuracy is 55.8% and crisis recall is 100%; the gap to the development set shows that keyword rules do not generalize, which is why a semantic classifier is planned. Remaining work includes natal chart comparison against independent fixtures, specialist validation of Vedic conventions, editorial review of Tarot meanings, I Ching line-text interpretation and full Thai/English coverage. Production adds authentication, encrypted storage, deletion, monitoring, scheduled jobs, cost limits and controlled prompt/rule releases.

Why AI? To write clear text in a chosen language and tone. **Why separate layers?** Positions, meanings and wording have different sources and failure modes. **What does Why show?** Source/rule factors only. **What remains unproven?** Whether users prefer and return for the loop; validate through interviews and a pilot.